

Kushal Badodekar

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SUMMARY

Security Engineer with 3+ years' experience securing enterprise networks and endpoints through incident response, advanced automation, and detection engineering. Skilled in triaging and resolving security incidents, and optimizing SIEM/EDR platforms (CrowdStrike, Splunk, Microsoft Defender). Proficient in threat hunting and driving vulnerability management to strengthen security posture. Recognized for critical thinking, proactive risk mitigation, and driving continuous improvement.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Cyber Forensics and Security - Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, IL, USA May 2025
Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science - Visvesvaraya Technological University, Karnataka, India June 2019

SKILLS

Tools & Platforms: CrowdStrike Falcon, Splunk, Microsoft Defender, Tenable, Wireshark, AWS, Azure, YARA, ServiceNow
Technical Skills: Incident Response, Threat Hunting, Malware Analysis, Vulnerability Management, SOAR, IDS/IPS
Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST-800, ISO 27001, SOX, Zero Trust, OWASP
Programming Languages: Python, Bash, SQL, PowerShell

WORK HISTORY

Security Analyst | *James Hardie Building Products – Chicago, USA* June 2024 – Dec 2024

- Enhanced 20+ EDR rules in **CrowdStrike Falcon** and **Defender**, cutting mean time to detect (**MTTD**) threats by 15% and accelerating incident response.
- Tuned 15+ **Splunk** SIEM rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK reducing false positives by 20% and boosting SOC productivity.
- Remediated **15+ Azure Entra ID** misconfigurations, preventing privilege escalation vectors and securing **10+ critical** business apps.
- Integrated **CASB** with Splunk to visualize cloud storage usage, driving data cleanup, saving over **\$120K** in annual cloud costs.
- Automated **20+ SOAR** workflows in **Python/PowerShell**, streamlining response and reducing triage time by 25%.
- Led **10+ STRIDE threat modeling** sessions, identifying and mitigating **15+** security risks in production environments.
- Achieved **95%** on-time remediation of critical vulnerabilities via **Tenable**-driven scans across **5,000+** assets.

Cybersecurity Engineer | *ATOS – India* April 2021 – Aug 2023

- Led and mentored 5+ analysts, running 10+ **tabletop attack/defense exercises** that reduced containment **SLAs** by **30%**.
- Scaled advanced **threat hunting** across 2,000+ endpoints and diverse log sources using **IOC/IOA** analysis, uncovering **15+** undetected attack patterns.
- Deployed **Abnormal Security** detection rules, reducing successful **phishing attacks** by **20%**.
- Implemented **vulnerability assessments** and expedited **patch management**, reducing critical findings and maintaining compliance with NIST/ISO standards.
- Reverse-engineered **10+ malware** samples to extract **IOCs**, improving detection accuracy & minimizing **missed threats**.
- Developed **25+ SOC incident response** playbooks, improving **triage efficiency** and standardizing processes.
- Launched phishing awareness campaigns using **KnowBe4**, reducing employee click rates by **25%**.

Network Engineer | *ATOS – India* Feb 2020 – March 2021

- Modernized **firewall policies** and optimized **Snort**-based **IDS/IPS** configurations, boosting threat prevention effectiveness by **40%** and reducing false positives by **25%**.
- Investigated 10+ security breaches by analyzing **Splunk** logs and endpoints, determining RCA and recommended mitigations.
- Automated patching for **1,500+** assets with **Ansible**, reducing SLA breaches for critical vulnerabilities by **30%**.
- Implemented **network segmentation** and VLAN policies, minimizing **lateral movement risk** and strengthening internal network defense.
- Managed **Palo Alto VPN** and secure remote access solutions, ensuring secure connectivity for global users and third parties.

CERTIFICATIONS AND COMPETITIONS

Certifications:

- CompTIA Security+
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- SOC Detection Engineering - Antisyphon
- Practical Malware Analysis & Triage

Competitions:

- CyberTruck, CyberTractor 2025 – Penetration Testing
- Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition 2024 – 4th Place
- Cyber Force 2023 – 5th Place, CTF & Anomaly Detection
- NCAE Cyber Games – 1st Regionals & 3rd Nationals.

PROJECTS

Malware Analysis

- Conducted in-depth analysis and triage of real-world malware samples, uncovering persistence, **command-and-control**, and evasion techniques.
- Developed custom **YARA** detection rules and automated threat identification scripts, accelerating response time for emerging threats.

AI Security

- Performed adversarial testing to identify and mitigate **AI/ML model vulnerabilities** - including data poisoning, evasion, and model inversion - using **MITRE ATLAS** and **ART** toolkits.
- Implemented defense strategies that improved AI model resilience and alignment with secure development standards.

Active Directory Security

- Designed and deployed a domain controller lab to enhance logging, threat detection, and attack surface reduction.
- Simulated advanced attacks (Kerberoasting, LLMNR, relay) to identify gaps and deploy countermeasures, reducing domain attack surface improving audit outcomes.

Hardware Security

- Performed firmware analysis and hardening on PLC/RTU devices; led red team attacks on OT protocols (Wireshark, J1939, Modbus, Ethernet/IP) in a segmented Purdue Model environment.
- Discovered and remediated ICS vulnerabilities, strengthening operational resilience and compliance for industrial networks.